

# TORI HELEN COTTON

(she/they)

*Curriculum Vitae*

Department of Logic and Philosophy of Science, University  
of California, Irvine

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## EDUCATION

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| <b>Ph.D., Logic and Philosophy of Science</b> , University of California, Irvine<br>Committee: Cailin O'Connor (Advisor), James Owen Weatherall, Kenny Easwaran, Allison Koslow   | <b>Expected July 2029</b> |
| <b>M.A., Logic and Philosophy of Science</b> , University of California, Irvine                                                                                                   | <b>July 2026</b>          |
| <b>M.A., Philosophy</b> , University of Arkansas<br>Thesis Title: "On Neo-Humean Accounts for Natural Laws"<br>Committee: Barry Ward (Advisor), Eric Funkhouser, Thomas D. Senior | <b>July 2023</b>          |
| <b>B.F.A., Studio Art (minor in Philosophy)</b> , University of Texas at Austin<br>Magna Cum Laude                                                                                | <b>Dec 2019</b>           |

## AREAS OF SPECIALIZATION & COMPETENCE

**AOS:** Social Epistemology; Philosophy of Science; Philosophy of AI; Computational Philosophy

**AOC:** Applied Ethics; Logic; Feminist Philosophy; Game Theory; Philosophy of Language

## PUBLICATIONS

### Peer-Reviewed Articles

A2. "The Problem With Who I Know: What Contextualism Can Tell Us About Interpersonal Knowledge Claims," *Southwest Philosophy Review*, July 2023.

A1. "On Draper's Hypothesis of Indifference," *SHERM Journal*, Summer 2023.

### Public Writing

PW1. "Review of *Philosophy of Computing: Themes from IACAP 2019*," *Philosophy of Science Association Newsletter*, June 2024.

## WORKS IN PROGRESS

W2. "Digital Dirty Laundry: Conversational AI and the Value of Unguarded Data," *under review, draft available*.

W1. "Scientific Metaphor and the Space Between Words," *draft available*.

## PRESENTATIONS

### Invited

V1. "Digital Dirty Laundry: Conversational AI and the Epistemic Value of Unguarded Data," *Epistemology of AI Conference*, UC Irvine and Chapman University, Feb 2026.

### Refereed

T4. "Fostering Research With Inference to the Best Explanation," *2022 annual meeting of the History and Philosophy of Science Division of the Mississippi Academy of Sciences*, Mississippi Academy of Sciences, Feb 2023.

T3. "Aristotle's Luck," *Beyond Free Will: Variety in Understanding of Choice, Luck, and Necessity*, Vilnius University, Jun 2022.

T2. "On Draper's Hypothesis of Indifference," *2nd Annual E-Conference on Atheism*, Global Center for Religious Research, Dec 2021. (Online).

T1. "Passion, Death, Acceptance: Buddhist Perspectives in the Philosophy of Emotion," *Marquette University Conference on the Philosophy of Death and Dying*, Marquette University, Apr 2021. (Online).

## PUBLIC TALKS AND COVERAGE OF WORK

PT5. "Graduate Student Flash Talk: Computational Methods for Studying Language," *LPS Undergraduate Summer Development Program*, UC Irvine, August 2026.

PT4. "Graduate Student Flash Talk: Climate News, Online Discourse, and the Limits of NLP for Studying Online Behavior," *LPS Undergraduate Summer Development Program*, UC Irvine, August 2024.

PT3. "Headlines and Hashtags: Climate News and Online Engagement," *Competitive Edge Research Symposium*, UC Irvine, Summer 2023.

PT2. "Wittgenstein Applied: The Language of Modern Politics," *Philosophy Dialogue Series*, Department of Philos-

ophy, Texas State University, October 2020 (online).

- PT1. "Women's Experiences in Academic Philosophy," *Filosofie: Research Shortcut*, Département de philosophie, Université du Québec à Montréal, November 2020 (online).

## COMMENTS GIVEN

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- C2. Commentator for Alexander Klein, "James's Solution to the Measurement Problem: Automatism Case Study," *SoCal Pragmatism Forum*, Oct 2024, UC Irvine.
- C1. Commentator for Devin Morse, "Communication and Liability," *Philosophy in the Ozarks*, Mar 2023, University of Arkansas.

## SERVICE

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- S25. Panelist, *LPS Undergraduate Summer Development Program*, Aug 2026, UC Irvine
- S24. Graduate Representative, *LPS Department*, July 2026–Ongoing, UC Irvine
- S23. Colloquium Chair, *Erica Schumener*, "Governing an Unruly World," May 2025, UC Irvine
- S22. Organizer, "Canvas & Conversation" (sponsored by the Hypatia Society), UC Irvine, May 2026
- S21. Organizer, The Hypatia Society, UC Irvine, Mar 2026–Ongoing
- S20. Presenter, "What does Graduate Student Research look like in LPS?", *LPS Visit Weekend*, UC Irvine, Feb 2026.
- S19. Panel Organizer and Moderator, Graduate Student Diversity and Community Panel (Hypatia & MAP), *LPS Visit Weekend*, UC Irvine, Feb 2026
- S18. Prospective Student Host, *LPS Visit Weekend*, UC Irvine, Feb 2026
- S17. Organizer, *Balance, Burnout, and Boundaries* (sponsored by DECADE), UC Irvine, Dec 2025
- S16. Colloquium Chair, *Sally Haslanger*, "Social Systems and Their Micro, Meso, and Macro Interactions," Oct 2025, UC Irvine
- S15. Graduate Representative, DECADE (Diverse Educational Community and Doctoral Experience), UC Irvine, Sep 2025–June 2026
- S14. Organizer and Referee, *UC Irvine & UC Riverside Joint Conference*, Sep 2025, UC Irvine
- S13. Co-Founder and Organizer, *Feminist Philosophy of Science Reading Group*, UC Irvine, Aug 2025–Ongoing
- S12. Panelist, *LPS Undergraduate Summer Development Program*, Aug 2025, UC Irvine
- S11. Department Librarian, *LPS Department*, Jul 2025–Ongoing, UC Irvine
- S10. Colloquium Chair, *Emily Sullivan*, "Idealization Failure in Science," Nov 2024, UC Irvine
- S9. Panelist, *LPS Undergraduate Summer Development Program*, Aug 2024, UC Irvine
- S8. Colloquium Chair, *Una Stojnić*, "Inquiry and Logical Form," May 2024, UC Irvine
- S7. Conference Referee, *Philosophy Graduate Conference*, Feb 2024, UC Irvine
- S6. Prospective Student Host, *LPS Visit Weekend*, UC Irvine, Feb 2024
- S5. Member, *Graduate Climate Committee*, Jan 2024–Ongoing, UC Irvine
- S4. Co-Founder, Organizer, and Referee, *Philosophy in the Ozarks Graduate Conference*, Mar 2023, University of Arkansas
- S3. President, *Logoi Graduate Philosophy Club*, Aug 2022–May 2023, University of Arkansas
- S2. Organizer, *24th Annual Texas State University Philosophy Student Symposium*, Apr 2021, Texas State University. (Online).
- S1. President, *Phi Sigma Tau, Delta Chapter*, Dec 2020–Aug 2021, Texas State University
- Journal Referee:** *Science Communication, New Media and Society*

## GRANTS, AWARDS, AND RECOGNITION

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- G11. Graduate Summer Research Award, \$4,000, Summer 2025
- G10. Graduate Summer Research Award, \$5,000, Summer 2024
- G9. Graduate Service Award, \$150, UC Irvine LPS, Spring 2024
- G8. Eugene-Cota Robles Fellowship, UC Irvine School of Social Sciences, \$34,000, Fall 2023–Summer 2024
- G7. Competitive Edge Summer Program Funding, UC Irvine, \$5,000, Summer 2023
- G6. Graduate-Professional Student Congress Travel Award, University of Arkansas, \$500, Spring 2023

- G5. Master Student Travel Grant, Department of Philosophy, University of Arkansas, \$600, Spring 2023  
 G4. Graduate-Professional Student Congress Travel Award, University of Arkansas, \$500, Spring 2022  
 G3. Master Student Travel Grant, Department of Philosophy, University of Arkansas, \$600, Spring 2022  
 G2. The Victor Holk Graduate Scholarship in Philosophy, Sustainability, and Creativity, Texas State University, \$1,000, Spring 2021  
 G1. Scholastic Leadership Award, Austin Community College, Summer 2019

## INTERDISCIPLINARY RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS

ProperAI Institute, Samueli School of Engineering, UC Irvine, Fall 2025–Ongoing.

## ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

### Instructor of Record

|                       |      |             |
|-----------------------|------|-------------|
| Making Modern Science | UCI  | Summer 2026 |
| Intro to Ethics       | UARK | Summer 2023 |
| Intro to Logic        | UARK | Spring 2023 |
| Intro to Logic        | UARK | Fall 2022   |
| Intro to Philosophy   | UARK | Summer 2022 |

### Teaching Assistant

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|------------------------------------------------|------|-------------|
| Race, Sex, and Science                         | UCI  | Winter 2026 |
| Critical Reasoning                             | UCI  | Fall 2025   |
| Honors: The Good Life                          | UCI  | Spring 2025 |
| Honors: Critical Issues in the Social Sciences | UCI  | Winter 2025 |
| Honors: Naturalized Epistemology               | UCI  | Fall 2024   |
| Intro to Philosophy                            | UARK | Spring 2022 |
| Intro to Philosophy                            | UARK | Fall 2021   |

### Research

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| <b>Graduate Student Researcher</b> , ProperAI Institute, Samueli School of Engineering                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | UCI  | Spring 2026           |
| <i>Interdisciplinary research on AI auditing, algorithmic monoculture, and fairness with James Owen Weatherall (LPS) and Yanning Shen (EECS).</i>                                                                                                                                                                                         |      |                       |
| <b>Graduate Research Assistant</b> for Bob Fischer, Department of Philosophy                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | TXST | Fall 2020–Summer 2021 |
| <i>Research support for <i>Animal Ethics: A Contemporary Introduction</i> (Routledge) and <i>A 21st Century Ethical Toolbox</i>, 5th ed. (OUP), as well as related journal articles, including interdisciplinary literature review across biology and environmental science, citation development, indexing, and background research.</i> |      |                       |

## WORKSHOPS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

*Disinformation Summer Institute*, Bainbridge Island, WA, June 2026  
*Competitive Edge Summer Research Program*, UC Irvine, Irvine, CA, Aug 2023  
*Quality Matters: Designing Your Online Course Workshop*, May 2021

*Last updated: July 13, 2026*